Alexey Zarakovskiy

Senior Backend Engineer; full-stack; language and technology agnostic

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/stack

LANGUAGES & FRAMEWORKS

Golang · Java · Spring Boot · Kotlin · Python · TypeScript · JS · CSS · Node.js · React · PHP

APIS, INTEGRATION & MESSAGING

Distributed Systems · REST · JWT · gRPC · Protobuf · GraphQL · Kafka · SQS/SNS

CLOUD, DATA & INFRASTRUCTURE AS CODE

AWS · GCP · AWS CDK · Helm · Terraform · PostgreSQL · DynamoDB · Redis · Elasticsearch

PLATFORM ENGINEERING & OPERATIONS

Kubernetes · CRDs · RBAC · Docker · GitHub Actions · ArgoCD · Prometheus · Grafana · Datadog

/experience

Prosus
Amsterdam

Oct 2026 - Present

Global technology group behind e-commerce brands.

Senior Software Engineer Golang

Toqan AI workspace

- Develop the Go-based AI harness connecting models to external tools, running multi-step agent workflows and deploying results.
- Deliver features and improve shared AI workflows and context handling.

Go · React · Agents · LLM · SQS · AWS · Datadog

Toptal
Remote

Apr 2026 - Present

Freelance Senior Backend Engineer Golang

Sabbatical *Focus on family, personal projects & AI engineering* Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

Personio
Amsterdam

Mar 2023 - Dec 2025

Intelligent HR platform serving `12k+` customers

Senior Backend Engineer 3 yrs 4 mos

Whistleblowing project Golang

- Co-architected and launched a greenfield EU-compliant whistleblowing service from product and regulatory requirements. Designed dual-AWS infrastructure and anonymous authentication for full anonymity and regulatory isolation. The launch generated approximately **`€1M ARR`** soon after release.
- Kickstarted the Go service and AWS CDK infrastructure. Led a maintenance team of **`3`** engineers post-launch.
- Coached engineers in Go, guided organizational adoption of the Go stack and its best practices, and remained the service's primary technical owner after launch.
- Delivered **`99.92%`** uptime with **`p99 <200ms`** latency, resolved **`14`** critical security vulnerabilities, and established automated testing with Docker Testcontainers and Datadog synthetic monitoring.

Surveys project Kotlin

- Led major platform features including a dashboard revamp, question result categorization, and date-driven dynamic filters. Built a user-data snapshot tool that prevents exponential database growth.
- Owned the zero-downtime migration of a **`24GB`** dataset after identifying the snapshot issue. Reduced P99 latency from **`600ms`** to **`<300ms`** across **`14`** endpoints through PostgreSQL index and schema optimization.

Golang · Kotlin · k8s · AWS · Helm · Postgres · Kafka · SQS · gRPC · Protobuf · TS · React · ArgoCD

BEAT | FREENOW Amsterdam

Sep 2019 – Jan 2023

Ride-hailing platform with **250k+** drivers

Senior Backend Engineer 3 yrs 4 mos

Pricing service Golang

- Led the extraction of the core pricing engine from the monolith into Go microservices and introduced dynamic incentive-driven pricing based on hexagonal geo-zones to balance driver supply and demand across markets.

API Gateway & Authentication service Golang

- Helped form a four-engineer team that extracted routing and authentication from the monolith. Built a dynamic Go API gateway handling **10k+ RPS** and a high-throughput, DynamoDB-backed authentication service.
- Ran the legacy and replacement routing and authentication paths side-by-side for **6–12 months**, completed the live migration, and removed the corresponding monolith functionality.
- Decentralized routing and authorization with custom Kubernetes CRDs, Helm-based automatic service discovery and route registration, and a Go authorization library adopted by all **7** cross-functional teams.
- Contributed CRD-based routing support to the open-source Skipper framework through PR **#2048**.
- Added a Redis idempotency guard for one-time JWT email signup tokens and built containerized integration tests for routing and authentication behavior during the migration.

Golang · Kubernetes · AWS · DynamoDB · Redis · Docker · Kafka · PHP · gRPC · Protobuf · OSS

fashionTrade Amsterdam

May 2018 – Jul 2019

Early-stage B2B fashion marketplace startup

Senior Backend Engineer 1 yr 3 mos

Data integration service Java

- Led implementation of a distributed data-integration API for hundreds of fashion wholesalers.
- API ingested messy customer data, disambiguated it with Elasticsearch-based fuzzy matching and enrichment, and mapped onto the master dataset via asynchronous Kafka pipelines with race-condition handling.

Java · Python · REST · Docker · Kafka · GCP · Kubernetes · Elasticsearch · Typescript · React

SDL Web Amsterdam

Oct 2015 – Apr 2018

Open-source adapter framework for an enterprise CMS

Senior Java Engineer 1 yr 8 mos **Team Lead** 11 mos

Developer Experience Accelerator framework Java

- Led development of the Java counterpart to an open-source enterprise CMS integration framework. Implemented reflection-based dynamic model mapping that reduced the time and effort needed for customer integrations, and reviewed and integrated community contributions.

Java · Groovy · Spring · Maven · Gradle · OSS · PowerShell · C#.NET

Earlier roles Poland & Russia

EPAM Systems - Consultancy (PayPal) · (Senior) Full-stack Engineer 3 yrs Java JS 2012–2015

L.I.C. - Workflows automation · Full-stack Engineer 1 yr 1 mo Java JS 2011–2012

Orange - Web studio · Full-stack Engineer / Co-founder 2 yrs 1 mo PHP JS 2009–2011

State factory - Real-time monitoring · Engineer 3 yrs C# C++ 2006–2009

/education

ITMO University Russia 2005–2011

Bachelor in Computer Science
Master in Computer Science

Exigen Services Russia 2011

UX Design Essentials Course